

Lemma. Let $\gamma: [c, d] \rightarrow [a, b]$ be a reparametrization of a curve $\alpha: [a, b] \rightarrow \mathbb{R}^3$. Then, the length of α is equal to the length of $\beta = \alpha \circ \gamma$.

Proof.

$$\text{length}(\beta) = \int_c^d \left| \frac{d\beta}{dr} \right| dr = \int_c^d \left| \frac{d\alpha}{d\gamma} \cdot \frac{d\gamma}{dr} \right| dr = \int_c^d \left| \frac{d\alpha}{d\gamma} \right| \cdot \left| \frac{d\gamma}{dr} \right| dr$$

WLOG, $d\gamma/dr > 0$, then

$$= \int_c^d \left| \frac{d\alpha}{d\gamma} \right| \frac{d\gamma}{dr} dr = \int_a^b \left| \frac{d\alpha}{d\gamma} \right| d\gamma = \text{length}(\alpha). \quad \square$$

If $\beta(s)$ is parametrized by arc length, then

$$|\beta'(t)| = \left| \frac{d\beta}{ds} \cdot \frac{ds}{dt} \right| = \left| \frac{d\beta}{ds} \right| \cdot \frac{ds}{dt} = 1$$

$$\Rightarrow \left| \frac{d\beta}{ds} \right| = \frac{dt}{ds} = \frac{1}{ds}$$

$$\Rightarrow S = \int_0^s \left| \frac{d\beta}{du} \right| du,$$